3p Slovenian Tarock

A point-trick game for three from Slovenia,
played with the 54-card Tarock deck

Traditional game • Rules written by Jonathan Ratschat

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Concept

3p Slovenian Tarock is the three-player form of Slovenian Tarock. In each deal, players bid for the right to choose the contract. The winner of the bidding is the **declarer** and plays alone against the other two, the **defenders**. Declarer and the defenders are the two **sides**.

In most contracts, declarer tries to take at least 36 of the 70 card points in tricks. Other contracts ask declarer to take no tricks or all of them. Both sides can also score **bonuses** for feats, such as winning the last trick with the lowest tarok. If nobody else bids, Forehand may choose **Klop**, in which everyone tries to take as few card points as possible.

Usually only declarer scores. At the end of the session, the player with the highest score wins.

Setup

Players: 3.

Cards: A 54-card Tarock deck, the same deck as for Austrian Tarock: 22 taroks and 32 suit cards.

Scoring: Pen and paper, one column per player.

Direction: Dealing, bidding, and play go to the right (anticlockwise).

Dealer: Choose the first dealer at random. After each deal, the player to the dealer's right deals next.

Forehand: The player to the dealer's right. Forehand has the highest priority in the bidding and leads the first trick in most contracts.

Deal

The dealer shuffles the cards well. The player to the dealer's left cuts them at least once. If they think the cards are not well shuffled, they may cut again, up to three more times. The dealer places the top **6 cards** face down in the middle as the **talon**. Nobody may change the order of the talon cards. Then the dealer deals packets of 8 cards, starting with Forehand, until each player has **16 cards**.

A player who has **no taroks** must show their hand. All cards are shuffled, and the same dealer deals again. After a dealing mistake, the same dealer also deals again.

A Deal at a Glance

Each deal follows these steps. The sections below explain each one.

1. **Deal:** Shuffle and cut. Then 6 cards face down as the talon and 16 cards to each player, in two packets of 8.
2. **Bidding:** Forehand opens with Three. Bid higher, hold an equal bid if you have higher priority, or pass.
3. **Talon:** In Three, Two, and One, declarer takes 3, 2, or 1 talon cards and discards as many.
4. **Announcements:** Bonuses and kontras, starting with declarer.
5. **Tricks:** Follow suit, otherwise play a tarok. Forehand leads, but from Beggar upward declarer leads.
6. **Scoring:** Only declarer scores, except in Klop, Mondfang, and Mistakes.

Cards

Taroks: The 22 taroks are permanent trumps. The **Škis** has no number and is the highest. Below it, the taroks rank from XXI, the **Mond**, down to I, the **Pagat**. Together, the Škis, the Mond, and the Pagat are the **trula**.

Suits: Clubs and spades are the black suits, hearts and diamonds the red suits. Each suit has four court cards (King, Queen, Knight, Jack) and four pip cards. From high to low, the cards rank:

- Black suits: King, Queen, Knight, Jack, 10, 9, 8, 7.
- Red suits: King, Queen, Knight, Jack, 1, 2, 3, 4.

In the red suits, the 1 is the highest pip card. Any tarok beats any suit card.

Table 1: Card points

Card	Card points
Škis, Mond, Pagat (the trula)	5
King	5
Queen	4
Knight	3
Jack	2
Any other card	1
Whole deck, counted in groups of three	70

Counting: After the last trick, each side counts the card points in its tricks (Table 1). In Klop, each player counts. Talon cards that a side received count as part of its tricks. Count the cards in groups of three. Each group is worth the sum of its card points minus 2. If 1 or 2 cards are left over, they are worth their sum minus 1. The two sides always have 70 card points together, so you only need to count one pile.

Examples:

- A King, a Queen, and the VII: $5 + 4 + 1 - 2 = 8$.
- Three pip cards: $1 + 1 + 1 - 2 = 1$.
- A Knight and a 9 left over: $3 + 1 - 1 = 3$.

Quick count: You can also count each card at its card points minus $\frac{2}{3}$. A King or a trula card is then worth $4\frac{1}{3}$, a Queen $3\frac{1}{3}$, a Knight $2\frac{1}{3}$, a Jack $1\frac{1}{3}$, and any other card $\frac{1}{3}$. Add up the pile and round to a whole number, $\frac{1}{3}$ down and $\frac{2}{3}$ up. The result is always the same as counting in groups of three. A Knight and a 9 give $2\frac{1}{3} + \frac{1}{3} = 2\frac{2}{3}$, which rounds up to 3.

Bidding

Bidding decides the declarer and the contract. Table 2 lists the contracts from lowest to highest.

Priority: Forehand has the highest priority, then the player to Forehand's right. The dealer has the lowest

priority.

Order: Forehand speaks first, then the player to Forehand's right, then the dealer. The bidding goes on around the table in this order.

Compulsory Three: Forehand's first bid is always Three. Nobody else may bid Three, so the lowest bid for the other players is Two. Slovenian players call this rule *obvezna tri* or *obvezna trojka*.

Your turn: Do one of the following:

- **Bid** a higher contract than the current bid.
- **Hold** by naming the same contract as the current bid. You may only hold if you have higher priority than the player who made that bid.
- **Pass**. You are then out of the bidding for this deal.

End: When all players but one have passed, the remaining player becomes **declarer** and plays the contract they named last.

Forehand's choice: If both other players pass on their first turn, Forehand plays Three, names a higher contract, or chooses **Klop**. Nobody else can ever choose Klop.

Example: Seated to the right, A is Forehand, then B, then C, who dealt. A opens with Three. B bids Two. C bids One, because B has priority over C. A holds One. B passes instead of bidding Beggar. C passes too, so A plays One.

Table 2: Contracts, from lowest to highest

Contract	Value	Goal
Klop *klop*	see Klop	Everyone alone. Fewest card points.
Three *tri*	10 + diff.	3 talon cards. 36+ card points.
Two *dve*	20 + diff.	2 talon cards. 36+ card points.
One *ena*	30 + diff.	1 talon card. 36+ card points.
Beggar *berač*	70	No tricks.
Solo Without *solo brez*	80	No talon. 36+ card points.
Valat *valat*	500	All tricks.

Contracts

Normal contracts: Three, Two, and One. Declarer uses the talon and needs **at least 36** card points. Only the normal contracts have a **difference** and **bonuses** (see Scoring and Bonuses).

Beggar: Declarer must not win a single trick. The rules for negative contracts apply (see Trick Play). As soon as declarer wins a trick, Beggar is lost and play can stop.

Solo Without: Declarer plays without the talon and needs at least 36 card points.

Valat: Declarer must win every trick.

Talon

Normal contracts: The talon is turned face up in its order and split into groups: two groups of 3 cards in Three, three groups of 2 in Two, and six single cards in One. Declarer takes one group into their hand.

Discard: Declarer then discards as many cards as they took, face down onto their trick pile. These cards count for declarer. You may not discard Kings or trula cards. You may discard other taroks, but you must show them.

The rest of the talon belongs to the defenders and counts as part of their tricks.

Other contracts: From Beggar upward, nobody looks at the talon. It counts for the defenders. In Klop, the talon cards are gifts (see Klop).

Announcements

After the talon exchange, or right after the bidding in contracts without one, there is a round of **announcements**. Declarer starts, then it goes to the right. On your turn, make as many announcements as you like, or pass. The round ends when all three players pass in a row, or when the other two players both pass after an announcement.

Bonuses: In the normal contracts, you may announce bonuses for your side (see Bonuses). You may announce the Trula or the Kings without holding the cards.

Kontra: In every contract except Klop, a defender may say **Kontra** to the contract. This doubles the contract value and the difference. Declarer may answer **Re** (×4), then the defenders **Sub** (×8), and then declarer **Mort** (×16).

An announced bonus can be kontra'd in the same way by the other side. Always name what you kontra, for example "Kontra to the Trula".

Bonuses

Bonuses exist only in the normal contracts. Table 3 lists them. Each bonus scores its **silent** value if nobody announced it, or its **announced** value if someone did.

Table 3: Bonuses

Bonus	Feat	Silent	Announced
Trula	One side takes Škis, Mond, and Pagat.	10	20
Kings	One side takes all four Kings.	10	20
Pagat Ultimo	The Pagat wins the last trick.	25	50
Valat	One side wins all 16 tricks.	250	500

Who may announce: Anyone may announce the Trula, the Kings, and Valat. Only the holder of the Pagat may announce Pagat Ultimo.

Silent Pagat Ultimo: It only counts if the Pagat is played to the last trick. It scores for the Pagat's side if the Pagat wins that trick, and against that side if not, even if the other defender wins the trick.

Announced bonuses: If the side achieves the feat, it scores the announced value. If not, it loses that value.

Ultimo duty: After announcing Pagat Ultimo, keep the Pagat until the last trick whenever the rules of play allow. If you have to play it earlier, the Ultimo fails.

Valat: A Valat replaces all other scores of the deal: contract, difference, and bonuses. An announced Valat cancels all other announcements, so the Pagat is no longer bound to the last trick.

Trick Play

First lead: In Klop and the normal contracts, Forehand leads to the first trick. From Beggar upward, declarer

leads.

Following: Play goes to the right. You must play a card of the led suit if you can. If you can't, you must play a tarok. If you have neither, play any card. When a tarok is led, you must play a tarok if you can.

Winning: The highest tarok in the trick wins. If the trick has no tarok, the highest card of the led suit wins. The winner leads the next trick.

No duty to beat: Except in the negative contracts, you never have to beat the cards already played.

Emperor's Trick: If the Škis, the Mond, and the Pagat are all played to the same trick, the Pagat wins it.

Negative contracts: In Klop and Beggar, two more rules apply to all players:

1. If one of your legal cards beats the trick so far, you must play such a card.
2. You may only play the Pagat when it is your last legal card, or when it is your only card that beats the trick (an Emperor's Trick).

Trick piles: Declarer keeps one trick pile, and the defenders share one.

Mondfang

In the normal contracts, a player whose Mond is captured scores **−21**. The Mond is captured when the Škis is played to the same trick, even by the other defender. This includes an Emperor's Trick.

In the normal contracts, declarer also scores −21 if they leave the Mond in the talon.

Mondfang only counts for the player who lost the Mond. Kontras and radelci never double it.

Scoring

Only declarer scores. The exceptions are Klop, Mondfang, and Mistakes. Write each player's running total in their column.

Contract: If declarer wins, they score the contract value. If declarer loses, they score minus that value.

Difference: In the normal contracts, the **difference** increases the win or the loss. It is declarer's card points minus 35. With 44 card points, declarer wins by 9. With 35, declarer loses by 0. With 24, declarer loses by 11.

Bonuses: Add each bonus that declarer achieves and each announced bonus that the defenders fail. Subtract each bonus that the defenders achieve and each announced bonus that declarer fails.

Kontra: A kontra multiplies only what it was said to, either the contract (value and difference) or one bonus.

Radelc: If declarer has a radelc, double declarer's whole score (see Radelci).

Example: A plays Two. B says Kontra to the contract. A takes 41 card points and all four Kings, while B and C take the trula. The contract scores $(20 + 6) \times 2 = 52$. The Kings add 10 and the Trula subtracts 10, so A scores 52. A has a radelc, so A scores 104 and fills in one radelc.

Radelci

After every deal of Klop, every contract from Beggar upward, and every deal in which a Valat is won or lost, each player gets a **radelc**. Draw a small circle under each player's name. The new radelci count from the next deal on.

Declarer: If declarer has at least one open radelc, declarer's score is doubled, for a win or a loss. If declarer won the contract, they fill in one radelc. If they lost, the radelci stay open.

In Klop: Every player who has an open radelc scores double. A player with an open radelc who takes no tricks fills one in.

Klop

Everyone plays alone and tries to take as few card points as possible. The rules for negative contracts apply. Forehand leads to the first trick.

Gifts: The winner of each of the first six tricks also takes the top talon card and shows it.

Scoring:

- A player who takes **no tricks** scores +70.
- A player who takes **more than 35** card points scores −70.
- If anyone scores +70 or −70, nobody else scores.
- Otherwise, each player scores minus their card points.

End of the Session

When you want to stop, play a **Škis round**. Play the deal as usual and note who was dealt the Škis. The next deal that this player deals is the last of the session. If the Škis was in the talon, play another Škis round.

After the last deal, each player scores −100 for each open radelc. The player with the highest score wins.

Mistakes

A player who breaks a rule is penalised. Examples are playing a wrong card, discarding a forbidden card, not beating in a negative contract, and giving away information about your cards.

That player alone scores minus the contract value, plus 35 in contracts that score a difference, plus every announced bonus. Kontras multiply this as usual, and it is doubled if declarer has an open radelc. Nobody else scores for that deal.

Common Variants

Agree on the variants you use before you start. Each one changes only what it says. Its sources are named in brackets and listed under Sources.

Deal and Bidding

- **Clockwise:** Mirror every direction in these rules. Dealing, bidding, and play go to the left, Forehand is the player to the dealer's left, and the player to the dealer's right cuts. *(TZS)*
- **Weak hands:** Before the bidding, a player with one tarok, or with two taroks both lower than X, may also show their hand, and the same dealer deals again. *(pagat)*
- **Three for everyone:** Forehand does not have to open with Three, and any player may bid Three. Priority and holding work as usual. Nobody may choose Klop, so Forehand's choice does not apply. If all three players pass, play Klop. *(pagat, Tarok.net, Repič)*
- **Raising:** After winning the bidding, and before the talon is turned up, declarer may name and play any contract higher than their last bid. *(pagat)*

Talon and Play

- **Taroks only when forced:** You may only discard a tarok if you have nothing else you are allowed to discard. Show it as usual. *(Tarok.net)*
- **Forehand leads Solo Without:** In Solo Without, Forehand leads to the first trick. *(Tarok.net, TZS)*

Contracts

- **Higher values:** Two is worth 30 and One is worth 50. Solo Without scores 80 plus the difference and has bonuses, as the normal contracts do. *(Tarok.net)*
- **Tournament Beggar:** Beggar is worth 125 and ranks above Solo Without. Only Valat ranks higher, and Valat may only be bid to overcall a Beggar. Play it without Open Beggar and Colour Valat. *(TZS)*
- **Open Beggar (90):** A contract that ranks just above Solo Without. Play it as Beggar, but after the first trick, declarer places their hand face up on the table. The defenders may not discuss their play. *(pagat)*
- **Colour Valat (125):** A contract without the talon, ranked just below Valat. Declarer leads to the first trick and must win every trick. Taroks only win when a tarok is led. When a suit card is led, the highest card of that suit wins. You must still play a tarok if you cannot follow suit. After the talon exchange in Three, Two, or One, declarer may also raise the contract to Colour Valat, which then also scores 125. *(pagat)*
- **Announced Valat:** In the round of announcements, declarer may announce Valat or Colour Valat on top of their contract. Colour Valat is then worth 125 in Three, 150 in Two, 175 in One, and 250 in Solo Without. Valat is worth 250, 300, 350, and 500. These values replace the announced Valat bonus and the raise to Colour Valat. Declarer leads to the first trick, and Colour Valat follows the rules of play above. Like any Valat, it replaces all other scores, and a failed one scores minus its value. *(Tarok.net)*

Bonuses and Kontras

- **Silent Valat:** An unannounced Valat is an ordinary bonus worth 50. It is added to the other scores instead of replacing them. *(Tarok.net)*
- **Defenders score their bonuses:** Bonuses of the defenders no longer count for or against declarer. An announced bonus scores its full value for the defender who announced it and half for the other. Silent Trula and Kings score 10 for each defender. A silent Pagat Ultimo scores 25 for its holder and 10 for the other defender. A failed bonus scores minus the same amounts. Valat counts as in the main rules. Use it with Kontra pays alone. *(Tarok.net)*
- **Protected defender:** When a defender's announced bonus or silent Pagat Ultimo fails, the other defender also scores its value. A kontra fails when the contract or bonus it was said to succeeds. After a defender's failed kontra, the other defender scores the points that the kontra added to declarer's score. *(TZS)*
- **Two kontra levels:** Only Kontra and Re. *(Tarok.net)*
- **Kontra pays alone:** A kontra only doubles the score of a failed contract or bonus, and Re doubles it again. If the contract or bonus succeeds, it scores its normal value, and the player who said Kontra also scores minus that value, or twice that after Re. A contract's value includes the difference. Nobody else's score changes. Use it with Two kontra levels. *(Tarok.net)*

Klop

- **Full at 35:** A player with 35 card points already scores −70. *(Tarok.net, TZS)*
- **No reward for no tricks:** Nobody scores +70, and a full player does not stop the others from scoring. Everyone else scores minus their card points. *(TZS)*
- **No radelci in Klop:** Radelci never double Klop scores, and nobody fills one in. *(Tarok.net)*
- **Kontra to the Klop:** Before the first lead, starting with Forehand, one player may say Kontra to the Klop. This doubles every Klop score. Then add one of two rules. In Tarok.net, a player who said Kontra and takes 18 or more card points scores double again. In TZS, if that player takes the most card points without being full, only their score is doubled. *(Tarok.net, TZS)*

Scoring and Radelci

- **Rounded difference:** Round the difference to the nearest 5. *(Tarok.net)*
- **Mond of the other defender:** If a defender's Škis captures the other defender's Mond, both defenders score −20 instead. *(Tarok.net)*
- **Emperor's Trick without Mondfang:** Losing the Mond in an Emperor's Trick does not count as Mondfang. *(TZS)*
- **Radelc on a loss:** Declarer fills in one radelc whether they win or lose. *(TZS)*
- **No radelc after Solo Without:** Solo Without gives no radelci. *(TZS until 2018)*
- **No cost for radelci:** Open radelci cost nothing at the end of the session. *(Tarok.net, Tarok 124)*

Session and Table

- **Fixed length:** Play an agreed number of deals instead of a Škis round. A Tarok.net match has 24, and TZS tournaments usually play rounds of 21. *(Tarok.net, TZS)*
- **Misdeal penalty:** The dealer scores −20 for each misdeal. *(TZS)* In Tarok.net, a player's first misdeal brings a warning instead, and further ones cost −20, −40, −60, and so on.
- **Deliberate mistakes:** A player who breaks a rule on purpose scores another −100. *(Tarok.net)*

Sources and Credits

These rules follow the three-player game on pagat.com and in the TZS rulebook. Common Variants lists where the sources below differ.

- John McLeod, *Slovenian Tarok*, pagat.com, based on a contribution by Zoran Obradovic. https://www.pagat.com/tarot/sltarok.html
- Miroslav Cigan, *Pravila taroka*, version 1.08 (2016), Tarok.net. https://www.tarok.net/pravila108.pdf
- Oljan Repič, *How to Win at Tarok* (2019), The Book Patch, ISBN 9781642544893.
- Tarok 124, comparison of rule books. https://124.si/en/stevec#rulebook-differences
- Tarok zveza Slovenije (TZS), *Pravila tekmovalnega taroka* (2010), Word file. https://tarokzveza.si/wp-content/uploads/2020/11/PRAVILA-TEKMOVALNEGA-TAROKA-16.01.2010.doc
- TZS, rule change for Solo Without (2018). https://tarokzveza.si/novice/sprememba-tekmovalnih-pravil-v-letu-2018/

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3p Slovenian Tarock — Player Reference

Version 0.17

A Deal at a Glance

1. **Deal:** Shuffle and cut. Then 6 cards face down as the talon and 16 cards to each player, in two packets of 8.
2. **Bidding:** Forehand opens with Three. Bid higher, hold an equal bid if you have higher priority, or pass.
3. **Talon:** In Three, Two, and One, declarer takes 3, 2, or 1 talon cards and discards as many.
4. **Announcements:** Bonuses and kontras, starting with declarer.
5. **Tricks:** Follow suit, otherwise play a tarok. Forehand leads, but from Beggar upward declarer leads.
6. **Scoring:** Only declarer scores, except in Klop, Mondfang, and Mistakes.

Cards

Taroks: Škis, XXI (Mond), XX … II, I (Pagat).
Black suits: King, Queen, Knight, Jack, 10, 9, 8, 7.
Red suits: King, Queen, Knight, Jack, 1, 2, 3, 4.

Card	Card points
Škis, Mond, Pagat (the trula)	5
King	5
Queen	4
Knight	3
Jack	2
Any other card	1
Whole deck, counted in groups of three	70

Counting: Groups of three are worth their sum minus 2. 1 or 2 cards left over are worth their sum minus 1.
Quick count: Each card is worth its card points minus $\frac{2}{3}$. Round the total $\frac{1}{3}$ down and $\frac{2}{3}$ up.

Contracts

Contract	Value	Goal
Klop *klop*	see Klop	Everyone alone. Fewest card points.
Three *tri*	10 + diff.	3 talon cards. 36+ card points.
Two *dve*	20 + diff.	2 talon cards. 36+ card points.
One *ena*	30 + diff.	1 talon card. 36+ card points.
Beggar *berač*	70	No tricks.
Solo Without *solo brez*	80	No talon. 36+ card points.
Valat *valat*	500	All tricks.

Normal contracts: Three, Two, One. Difference: declarer's card points − 35.

Bidding

Priority and order: Forehand, then to the right, dealer last. Forehand opens with Three. Bid higher, hold with higher priority, or pass for good. If both others pass on their first turn, Forehand plays Three, a higher contract, or Klop.

Talon

Groups of 3, 2, or 1 cards, in order. Discard as many cards face down. Never Kings or trula cards. Show discarded taroks. The rest of the talon counts for the defenders.

Bonuses

Normal contracts only.

Bonus	Feat	Silent	Announced
Trula	One side takes Škis, Mond, and Pagat.	10	20
Kings	One side takes all four Kings.	10	20
Pagat Ultimo	The Pagat wins the last trick.	25	50
Valat	One side wins all 16 tricks.	250	500

Announce: Trula, Kings, and Valat anyone, Pagat Ultimo only its holder. A silent Pagat Ultimo counts only if the Pagat is in the last trick. A Valat replaces all other scores.

Kontra

Kontra ×2, Re ×4, Sub ×8, Mort ×16. Each applies to the contract or to one bonus. Not in Klop.

Trick Play

Forehand leads the first trick, from Beggar upward declarer. The winner of a trick leads the next.

Follow suit, otherwise play a tarok. No duty to beat. Škis, Mond, and Pagat in one trick: the Pagat wins.

Negative contracts (Klop, Beggar): Beat the trick if you can. Play the Pagat only as your last legal card or to win an Emperor's Trick.

Scoring

Usually only declarer scores. A win scores plus the contract value and difference, a loss minus. Then add or subtract each bonus. Each kontra multiplies its item.

Mondfang: Normal contracts only. −21 for the player whose Mond falls with the Škis, or for declarer who leaves it in the talon. Never doubled.

Radelci: Everyone gets one after Klop, Beggar upward, or a Valat. Declarer's radelc doubles their score. A win fills one in. −100 per open radelc at the end.

Klop: The first six tricks each take a talon card. No tricks +70. More than 35 card points −70, and then nobody else scores. Otherwise minus own card points.